

August 2026

Dear Jennifer,

I've worked in Orinda long enough to know that a fully remodeled mid-century home on a private .39-acre lot surrounded by heritage oaks doesn't come along very often, and 130 La Espiral caught my attention the moment it hit the market. The combination of soaring ceilings, a marble-faced fireplace, and those expansive decks with tree-framed views is exactly the kind of thing serious Orinda buyers talk about when they describe what they're looking for. So when the listing came off the market without a sale after 54 days, I wanted to reach out, because I don't think the home was the problem.

Fifty-four days is past the point where buyer psychology shifts. Once a listing crosses the 45-day mark, buyers stop asking 'Is this the right home?' and start asking 'Why is it still available?' That question isn't fair to a home like this one, but it's real, and a standard MLS approach doesn't have a good answer for it. What I also noticed was that the listing description, while accurate, leaned heavily on the physical inventory of updates without ever putting a buyer inside the experience of living there. The wine cellar, the smart lighting, the primary suite deck with views of the oak canopy, those details deserved more than a mention in a long list. The story of this home never fully got told.

I've put together a short analysis of what I believe happened strategically, and what a relaunch would need to look like to reach the buyers who are genuinely right for this property. It's specific to 130 La Espiral, not a generic overview of the market, and I think you'll find it useful whether or not you decide to work with me.

If you're already working with a real estate agent toward a new listing, please feel free to disregard this entirely, and I wish you a smooth and successful sale. If you're not, I'd welcome a conversation at your convenience, no pressure and no obligation.

With respect,

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read 'Ben Olsen', with a long horizontal line extending to the right.

Ben Olsen

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The Path to Sold:

130 La Espiral

Orinda, CA 94563

4.0 Beds · 4 Baths · 2,559 Sq Ft · Orinda

The Blueprint for a Successful Sale

Prepared For: The Owners of 130 La Espiral

Presented By: Ben Olsen · BrightWork Realty Advocates

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A Fully Remodeled Mid-Century Retreat with Heritage Oak Views - and a Listing That Didn't Show It

130 La Espiral has the ingredients that Orinda buyers at this price point actively seek: a complete top-to-bottom renovation, soaring ceilings with an open main level, a dramatic marble-faced fireplace, picture windows framing a private .39-acre lot wrapped in mature heritage oaks, a hidden wine cellar, a primary suite with its own deck, and smart home features throughout. The home sits in the Orinda Country Club corridor with access to top-rated schools including Sleepy Hollow Elementary and Miramonte High, BART, and Highway 24, all meaningful checklist items for the relocating SF or East Bay buyer who shops this neighborhood.

The listing history doesn't reflect the home's quality. At \$860 per square foot and 54 days on market without a sale, the gap between fundamentals and outcome points to a strategy problem, not a value problem. The listing description catalogued the renovations accurately but never built the emotional and experiential case that justifies \$2,200,000 to a careful, well-informed buyer. The visual assets, particularly the oak tree setting, the deck living, and the architectural character of the mid-century bones, appear to have been underrepresented in how the home was presented online, which is where buyers at this price point do most of their filtering before they ever schedule a showing.

\$2,200,000

List Price

\$860/sqft

Price Per Sq. Ft.

None

HOA Fees

A relaunch needs to accomplish one specific thing: put the right buyer inside the experience of this home before they arrive in person. That means cinematic visual storytelling of the oak canopy setting and indoor-outdoor flow, a listing narrative that speaks to the lifestyle rather than the inventory of upgrades, and distribution that actively finds the SF and East Bay buyer who is researching Orinda but hasn't found the right property yet.

MARKET FORENSICS: WHY IT DIDN'T SELL

Every expired listing has a story. Here's what the listing history tells us about what held this one back, and what a different strategy would have done.

Friction #1: Stale Listing Psychology After 54 Days

At 54 days on market, 130 La Espiral crossed the threshold where buyer perception shifts in a meaningful way. Past the 45-day mark, buyers who encounter a listing for the first time don't see a home that's still available, they see a home that everyone else passed on. That stigma has nothing to do with the quality of the renovation or the .39-acre lot with heritage oaks. It's a byproduct of a distribution strategy that ran out of reach before it found the right buyer. The buyers who would recognize immediately what this home offers, particularly well-informed relocators from San Francisco and the East Bay, likely never saw it at the right moment in their search. A relaunch built around active buyer outreach, not passive MLS presence, changes that dynamic.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork uses geo-targeted digital campaigns to reach SF and East Bay buyers who are actively researching Orinda before they've found what they're looking for, putting this home in front of decision-makers rather than waiting for them to stumble across it.

Friction #2: A Visual Story That Was Never Fully Told

A mid-century home on a private lot surrounded by heritage oaks, with expansive decks, soaring ceilings, and picture windows framing the tree canopy, lives and dies on how it's presented visually. Standard MLS photography captures rooms. It rarely captures the experience of standing on that deck at dusk with oak branches overhead, or the way natural light moves through those picture windows across new wood floors. At \$2,200,000, buyers are comparing carefully, and a home with this much architectural and environmental character needs visual media that communicates depth, not just dimensions. Without that, the features that set 130 La Espiral apart from a standard Orinda renovation registered as line items rather than reasons to act.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's Sky Tour gives buyers aerial context that shows the lot position, the oak canopy setting, and the relationship between the home and its surroundings in a way no ground photography or satellite image can replicate.

Friction #3: Narrative Failure - The Listing Described the Home, It Never Sold It

The listing description for 130 La Espiral was accurate, but it read as a checklist. New roof, stainless appliances, smart lighting, wine cellar, two-car garage, the features were named but the experience of living in this home was never rendered for the reader. A buyer scanning listings at this price point needs to feel something before they'll drive to Orinda for a showing. The wine cellar hidden off the main living level, the primary suite deck framing a private oak landscape, the indoor-outdoor flow from kitchen to barbecue deck, these are the details that separate a \$2,200,000 purchase from a \$1,600,000 alternative, and they were buried in a paragraph that read the same as every other remodeled listing in the market. The home had a story worth telling. The listing never told it.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's Zillow Showcase placement pairs premium listing narrative, written the way a great buyer's agent describes a home, with enhanced portal visibility that routes every buyer inquiry directly back to the listing team.

POSITIONING ANALYSIS

Metric	130 La Espiral	Orinda Market Context
Price per Sq. Ft.	\$860/sqft	Orinda architectural/character tier: \$860–\$950/sqft
Lot / Setting	16,900 sqft (.39 acres), private, mature heritage oak canopy	Typical Orinda lot: 8,000–14,000 sqft, standard landscaping
Architectural Character	Mid-century structure, fully remodeled, soaring ceilings, marble fireplace	Most inventory: standard updated ranches and traditional colonials
Premium Features	Hidden wine cellar, primary suite deck, smart lighting, expansive entertaining decks, new roof	Standard floor plan with updated kitchen and baths
HOA	None	None to \$300/mo depending on community

The verdict: At \$860/sqft versus a benchmark range of \$860-\$950/sqft, this home sits near the lower end of that range. At \$860 per square foot, 130 La Espiral sits at the entry point of the architectural and character-home tier for Orinda, which is a defensible and reasonable position given the full renovation, the mid-century bones, and a private oak-canopy lot that is meaningfully larger than typical Orinda inventory. The pricing was not the problem. The marketing needed to build the specific visual and narrative case that moves a buyer from 'this looks interesting' to 'this is the one,' and that case was never fully made.

THE RELAUNCH STRATEGY: 3 PILLARS

We don't re-list this home. We relaunch it with new media, a narrative that finally does it justice, and distribution designed for the buyer it deserves.

Pillar I - Build the Visual Case the Oak Setting Deserves

The .39-acre lot with mature heritage oaks and the home's relationship to that landscape are among the most compelling reasons to choose 130 La Espiral over any other fully remodeled home in Orinda right now. That story requires visual media that goes well beyond interior room shots. A Sky Tour showing the canopy, lot position, and setting gives buyers who are researching online the spatial and environmental context that makes the price make sense before they ever schedule a visit. Buyers who arrive having already experienced the setting through immersive media show up ready to act, not still forming an opinion.

Pillar II - Write the Listing for the Buyer Who Needs to Feel It First

At \$2,200,000, the buyers who are right for this home are not impulse shoppers. They are comparing carefully, reading listing descriptions closely, and deciding whether a showing is worth their time based on how a home makes them feel online. The hidden wine cellar, the primary suite deck, the indoor-outdoor flow from the kitchen to the oak-framed barbecue deck, these details need to be rendered in language that puts a buyer inside the experience, not catalogued in a bullet list. A 3D Matterport tour running alongside a well-crafted narrative gives out-of-area buyers and busy professionals the confidence to commit to a showing, and to a number, before they walk in the door.

Pillar III - Reach the Buyer Who Is Looking for Orinda Without Knowing This Address Yet

The buyer for 130 La Espiral is likely working in San Francisco or Oakland, considering a move to Lamorinda, and doing a significant amount of research online before they engage an agent or schedule showings. A passive MLS presence waits for that buyer to find the listing. An active distribution strategy goes to find them, specifically through geo-targeted digital campaigns that surface this home to buyers who are researching Orinda but haven't yet identified the right property. Paired with BrightWork's off-market private buyer list at offmarket.brightworkrealty.com, that approach creates a clean relaunch with fresh eyes, no stale days-on-market counter, and a buyer pool that is genuinely ready.

A DIFFERENT OPTION: THE QUIET LISTING

Sell Without the Disruption

A traditional listing puts a sign in your yard, opens your door to strangers every weekend, and puts your home's history on public record. For a home that already went through one listing cycle, there's a better starting point.

BrightWork maintains an active private buyer list through our off-market platform. These are Bay Area buyers who've opted in specifically to receive property alerts before anything hits Zillow. They're motivated, pre-qualified, and they believe an off-market home represents a real opportunity, which means they engage seriously.

- * **No public days on market.** The prior listing history stays private. A new buyer sees none of it.
- * **No sign, no open houses, no disruption.** The sale is a private conversation between a motivated buyer and a motivated seller.
- * **Option to go public anytime.** If the right off-market offer doesn't materialize in an agreed window, we transition directly into a full relaunch strategy with no time lost.

* HOW IT WORKS

We alert our private buyer list through offmarket.brightworkrealty.com - Bay Area buyers specifically seeking properties before they go public. If a serious match emerges within the agreed window, we negotiate and close privately. If not, we launch the full relaunch strategy immediately, with clean momentum and no days-on-market exposure.

TIMELINE: THE BRIGHTWORK SMART WAY

Phase 1 - Pre-Market Preparation (Weeks 1–2)

Staging, full media production, and a Coming Soon campaign - or a quiet listing launch to our private buyer network, depending on your preference.

Phase 2 - Strategic Launch (Week 3)

Thursday launch on Zillow Showcase with the full media package in premium placement. Targeted SF/Oakland digital ads go live the same day.

Phase 3 - Momentum Management (Weeks 4–5)

Active follow-up on every save, inquiry, and open house visitor. Final Offer gives serious buyers a transparent channel to submit competitive offers.

Phase 4 - The Close (Weeks 6–7)

We engineer competition, not just field offers. Our process keeps both sides of the transaction moving cleanly toward a close.

WHY BRIGHTWORK REALTY ADVOCATES

- * **Deep local roots:** 45+ years in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda. Ground-level knowledge of what buyers in each community are actually paying for.
- * **Premium marketing as a baseline:** Cinematic photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not a luxury add-on.
- * **Portal dominance:** Zillow Showcase and homes.com premium placement. More views, enhanced listing pages, all leads to your team.
- * **Modern offer tools:** Final Offer gives buyers a transparent path to engage and gives you real-time demand data in one place.
- * **True advocacy:** We don't re-list homes. We forensically review what went wrong and rebuild the strategy from the ground up.

This home has real assets that the market never got to properly evaluate. That's a correctable problem. The window to correct it is still open.

Ready to talk? brightworkrealty.com · (925) 255-9727

Scan to see what a relaunch looks like for your home: relaunch.brightworkrealty.com

Important Notice

If you have entered into a listing agreement or active representation agreement with a licensed real estate agent in connection with this property, please disregard this mailing.

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The market analysis and strategic observations contained in this report are based on publicly available listing data and BrightWork's professional assessment of market conditions. They are not a formal appraisal and should not be relied upon as a certified valuation.

All property data referenced in this report was obtained from public records and MLS history. BrightWork Realty Advocates makes no warranty as to the accuracy of third-party data sources.

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